



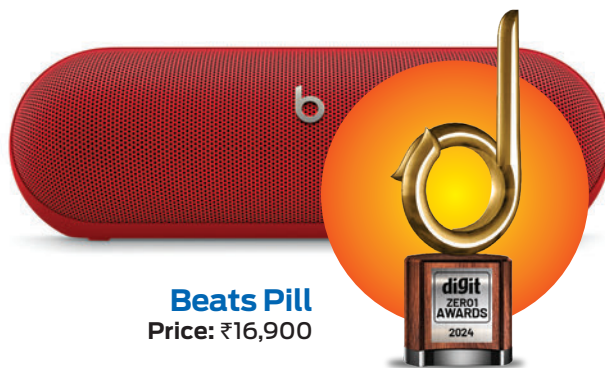
Bluetooth Speakers

Go loud and clear, or go home

The Bluetooth speaker market in India has seen rapid growth, driven by the rise of smartphones, music streaming, and a growing middle class. With more people seeking portable, high-quality sound for both indoor and outdoor use, competition among brands has never been fiercer. Bluetooth speakers in India have evolved from basic audio devices to smart, durable, and feature-packed gadgets. Thanks to advancements like Bluetooth 5.3 and voice assistant integration, amongst a plethora of other features also trickling down from the premium offerings into more budget-friendly packages, the speakers from brands across the board are now better than ever, delivering sound quality and convenience in a portable form.

Winner: Beats Pill

The Beats Pill has set a solid benchmark for portable speakers, combining thoughtful engineering with dependable sound performance. Unlike many of its peers that use passive bass radiators, the Pill employs internal drivers to produce a sound that feels well-rounded and balanced. The speaker features a racetrack-style neodymium woofer paired with a single neodymium tweeter. Testing the speaker with bass-heavy tracks revealed a strong low-frequency response. At higher volumes, however, there was some distortion and treble tones on high-frequency elements, like cymbals, sounded a bit sharp. It's not a dealbreaker, but it does highlight the lack of an adjustable EQ, which could have added some flexibility for those who like to tweak their audio settings. On the connectivity front, the speaker includes Bluetooth 5.3 with support for AAC and SBC codecs, ensuring compatibility with a wide range of devices. That said, the absence of aptX or other Android-optimized



Beats Pill
Price: ₹16,900

codecs is worth noting. Even so, its compact design and reliable sound quality make it a great choice for those who value portability and a straightforward listening experience, getting it the top spot in the Digit Zero1 Awards 2024 in the Best Performing Bluetooth Speaker Category.

Best Buy: Sony Ult Field 7

The Sony Ult Field 7 stands out as a value-for-money choice for consumers seeking performance without compromise while also coming in stunningly close to the Beats Pill in the race to the top spot in the Zero1 Awards, missing out by just 1 point. Winner of the Digit Best Buy Award, it offers a feature-packed experience at a price which you would honestly not mind shelling out. Sony's trademark design philosophy shines through in the Ult Field 7, which combines durability and versatility. The audio performance is balanced across lows, mids, and highs, delivering clarity and depth. Bass is tight and punchy, mids are finely tuned for clear vocals and instruments, and highs are crisp and detailed, making it suitable for diverse music genres. With customisable EQ settings via Sony's companion app, users can tailor the sound to their preferences, whether boosting bass for parties or enhancing mids for podcasts. Battery life is a highlight, offering up to 24 hours on a single charge. Fast charging adds convenience, ensuring minimal downtime. Connectivity is seamless with Bluetooth 5.2, providing stable connections and low latency. Compatibility with AAC, SBC, and LDAC codecs ensures high-quality audio for both iOS and Android users. The Field 7's built-in microphone enables hands-free calls and voice assistant integration, adding to its versatility. Intuitive controls and voice feedback simplify operation, even on the go. Its IP67 rating guarantees resilience against water and dust, making it suitable for beach outings and mountain treks alike. Additional features like stereo pairing allow users to connect two units for an enhanced soundstage, perfect for group settings. The ambient noise reduction ensures clear call quality, further enhancing its utility. Combining impressive audio clarity, customisation options, and long-lasting battery life, the Sony Ult Field 7 is a reliable companion for both leisure and productivity.

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Sony Ult Field 7
Price: ₹39,990